SWEET SUCCESS

VINEETA SINGH, 38

Co-founder and CEO, Sugar Cosmetics, **Mumbai**



MANDAR DEODHAR

Singh famously gave up a crore-rupee job offer from an investment bank while she was still in her twenties because she wanted to build a firm of her own. Sugar Cosmetics, a digital-first brand, is her third start-up—the first two failed, but that did not dampen her enthusiasm. Pouring her learning and consumer insights into Sugar, which she co-founded in 2015, the IIT and IIM graduate has scaled up the firm to around 35,000+ retail touchpoints in over 130 cities across India. In 2020-21, the firm achieved Rs 130 crore in revenue, and raised $21 million (Rs 160 crore) in venture funding, bringing its valuation to Rs 750 crore. Her mantra is to make cosmetics for Indian skin tones and the Indian environment. Singh, who runs the company with her husband, is optimistic of future growth—the Indian beauty market as a whole is estimated to be worth about Rs 10,000 crore. ■

–Shwweta Punj

RUNNING A BUSINESS Singh is an ultra-marathoner and has completed the 89-km Comrades Marathon in South Africa three years in a row